Lilly's Purple Plastic Purse

By Kevin Henkes

Interper should create a distinct character for each character, including the narrator.

NARRATOR: Lilly LOVED school.

LILLY: I Love School!

NARRATOR: She loved the pointy pencils. *(pantomime Lilly sharpening a pencil)* She loved the squeaky chalk *(pantomime Lilly screeching the chalk down the board and it hurting her ears, but she LIKES it)*. And she loved the way her boots went clickety-clack down the long, shiny hallway *(pantomime walking down the hallway happily).* Lilly loved the privacy of her own desk

LILLY: *(opensthe lid of an old school desk and peeksover the edge as if she has a secret inside)* – Mine!

NARRATOR: She loved the fish sticks and chocolate milk every Friday in the lunchroom!

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LILLY: *(drinks nosily through a straw)* Straws make everything taste better!

NARRATOR: And, most of all, she loved her teacher, Mr. Slinger.

LILLY: *(Holds up flowers)* For you!

INTRODUCTION

Raise your hand if you like school . . . . or if you LIKED school when you were a kid. I thought not . . . not many kids wake up early in the morning excited about the prospect of a day of learning and enlightenment . . . or to go sit in a stuffy classroom and be bored! ALL. DAY.

In this story you'll meet a little girl who loves school because she has a fantastic teacher . . . Fantastic, that is, until the day he takes away Lilly's Purple Plastic Purse by Kevin Henkes.

NARRATOR: Mr. Slinger was sharp as a tack. *(Lilly interrupts . . . Or as a pencil! And laughs. Narrator gives her a stern look)* He wore artistic shirts. *(pantomime Mr. Slinger selecting a shirt and putting it on)* He wore glasses on a chain around his neck. *(pantomime putting glasses on*

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and waving at random people) And he wore a different colored tie for each day of the week.

MR. SLINGER: *(holding up different ties)* No . . . No . . . . Yes!

LILLY: WOW!

NARRATOR: That was just about all she could say.

LILLY: WOW!

NARRATOR: And he always provided the most tasty snacks –

MR. SLINGER: Curly, crunchy and cheesy! *(Hold up a snack, Lilly takes it and savors it)*

LILLY: I wanna be a teacher when I grow up!

NARRATOR: At home, Lilly pretended to be Mr. Slinger!

LILLY: I am the teacher *(speaking to her baby brother)* Listen up! Teacher know everything!

MOTHER: What's with Lilly?

FATHER: I thought she wanted to be a surgeon or an ambulance driver or a diva.

MOTHER: It must be because of her new teacher, Mr. Slinger.

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FATHER: WOW!

NARRATOR: Said her father. That was just about all he could say.

FATHER: WOW

NARRATOR: When students had free time, they were permitted to visit the Lightbulb Lab in the back of the classroom. There they expressed their ideas creatively through drawing and writing. Lilly went often and had many ideas. She drew pictures of Mr. Slinger and wrote stories about Mr. Slinger. And then during sharing time, she would share her creations with the rest of the class.

LILLY: And at the very last second, Mr. Slinger saved the cold, starving, elderly . . . .

MR. SLINGER: WOW

NARRATOR: said Mr. Slinger. That was about all he could say.

MR. SLINGER: WOW

NARRATOR: When Mr. Slinger had bus duty, Lilly stood in line. Even though she didn't ride the

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bus. And Lilly raised her hand more than anyone else in the class. Even if she didn't know the answer.

LILLY: *(frantically raising her hand)* Call on me . . . please, please!!!

NARRATOR: And Lilly volunteered to stay after school to help lap erasers.

LILLY: *(clapping erasers – clap, clap, cough, cough)* I wanna be a teacher when I grow up!

MR. SLINGER: Excellent choice!

NARRATOR: [One] Monday morning, Lilly showed up to school especially happy. She had gone shopping with her Grammy over the weekend and had a new pair of movie star sunglasses, complete with glitter and a chain like Mr. Slingers. She had 3 shiny quarters, and best of all; a brand new purple plastic purse that played a jaunty tune when it was opened. *(pantomime Lilly admiring and opening a purse and then moving to the music)*

LILLY: I can't wait to show everybody!

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MR. SLINGER: Not now, Lilly, Listen to our story.

NARRATOR: Lilly had a hard time listening. Lilly really wanted to show everyone

MR. SLINGER: Not now. Let's be considerate of our classmates.

NARRATOR: Lilly had a hard time being considerate.

MR. SLINGER: Not now, Lilly – Wait until recess or Sharing time. *(pantomime Mr. Slinger sliding his glasses down his nose and giving a disapproving look)*

NARRATOR: Lilly could not wait.

LILLY: "Look!" *(whispers Lilly fiercely)* "Look, everyone! Look what I've got!"

NARRATOR: Everyone looked. Including Mr. Slinger. He was not amused.

MR. SLINGER: I'll just keep your things at my desk until the end of the day. They will be safe there and then you can take them home.

LILLY: I feel like crying! My glasses . . . gone. My quarters . . . gone. My purple plastic purse . . . GONE!!

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NARRATOR: Lilly longed for her purse all morning. She was even too sad to eat the snack Mr. Slinger served before recess. That afternoon, Lilly went to the Lightbulb Lab. *(pantomime Lilly walking sadly and dejectedly).* She was still very sad. And then she became angry. *(Lilly's walk changes from sad to stomping).* And then she became furious. She drew a picture of Mr. Slinger *(pantomime Lilly drawing with an evil smile and making faces)*

LILLY: Mr. Big, Fat, Mean, Stealing Teacher . . . wanted by the FBI. PS: I do not want to be a teacher when I grow up.

NARRATOR: Right before the last bell rang, Lilly sneaked the drawing into Mr. Slinger's book bag. *(Lilly pantomimes this narration.)* Then when all the students were buttoned, zipped, tied and ready to go home, Mr. Slinger strolled over to Lilly and gave her purple plastic purse back.

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MR. SLINGER: It's a beautiful purse. Your quarters are nice and jingly. And those glasses are absolutely fabulous. You may bring it back to school as long as you don't disturb the rest of the class.

LILLY: *(pouting)* I don't want to be a teacher when I grow up.

NARRATOR: And Lilly marched out of the classroom. On the way home, Lilly opened her purse. Her glasses and quarters were inside. And so was a note from Mr. Slinger.

MR. SLINGER: Today was a difficult day. Tomorrow will be better.

NARRATOR: There was also a small bag of snacks at the bottom of the purse.

LILLY: Oh man! I feel awful! I feel simply terrible!

NARRATOR: Lilly rushed home and told her mother and father everything. Then instead of watching her favorite cartoons, she decided to sit in the "uncooperative chair."

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LILLY: I'll stay here a million years for Mr. Slinger. Why does everything always happen to me. I'm really, really, really sorry. I'll draw a new picture of Mr. Slinger and write a new story too! . . . . . So everyone forgave Lilly including her especially incredible teacher and the sun smiled its face done on everyone and everything including the bugs and the worms . . . . The end.

NARRATOR: Lilly's mother wrote a note. And Lilly's father baked some tasty snacks for Lilly to take to school the next day. The next morning Lilly showed up early to school.

LILLY: Um . . . Mr. Slinger? These are for you because I'm really, really, really, really, really, really, really sorry.

NARRATOR: Mr. Slinger read the story and looked at the picture and sampled the snacks.

MR. SLINGER: WOW

NARRATOR: Said Mr. Slinger. That was about all he could say.

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MR. SLINGER: Wow . . . well, what should we do about this?

LILLY: *(Sheepishly)* Mr. Big, Fat Stealing . . . can we just throw it away?

MR. SLINGER: Excellent idea.

NARRATOR: [That afternoon] During Sharing Time, Lilly demonstrated the many uses and uique qualities of her purple plastic purse, her shiny quarters, and her movie star sunglasses. Then she did a performance using them as props.

LILLY: *(dancing)* It's called interpretive dance!

NARRATOR: Then Mr. Slinger served Lilly's snack to the class.

MR. SLINGER: What do you guys wanna be when you grow up?

KIDS: A Teacher!

NARRATOR: But Lilly's response was the loudest. On her way home Lilly thought to herself.

LILLY: Mr. Slinger was right. Today was a better day. And I really do want to be a teaher. This when I don't' want to be a surgeon, or an ambulance

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dirve, or a diva or a scuba diver, or a dancer or

a . . . . .

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